

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

INTRODUCTION

Hospitality didn't start as a business.

It started as a responsibility.

Long before restaurants, bars, hotels, stadiums, or any structured venue existed, there was a simple expectation: if someone entered your space—physically or otherwise—you took care of them. You acknowledged them. You made them feel safe, welcome, and valued.

That wasn't branding.

That wasn't strategy.

That was the standard.

So we're going back to that.

Because you can't understand where hospitality is going until you understand where it came from—and what it was always meant to be.

In ancient civilizations, this responsibility wasn't just cultural—it was enforced.

In Babylonian times, tavern keepers who watered down beer could be put to death. Not fined. Not warned. Executed.

Extreme? Maybe.

But it makes one thing clear: the experience of the guest was taken seriously. Integrity wasn't optional. Trust wasn't negotiable. If you failed the people you served, it mattered—because the role you played mattered.

Somewhere along the way, we drifted from that.

Not all at once. Not intentionally.

But gradually. Quietly.

We replaced attentiveness with efficiency.

We replaced connection with transactions.

We replaced experience with optimization.

And in doing so, we didn't just change operations—we changed what people feel.